

EA HOSPITALITY PULSE

Daily intelligence for city, bush & beach properties across East Africa

Sunday Foresight

2026-08-23

Four stories this week. One argument underneath.

THE TOURIST SHILLING IS BEING RE-NATIONALISED

On 18 August the Zanzibar Commission for Tourism, with Immigration, arrested three people for running excursions. The offence was nationality: under the Tourism Act 2009 tour operating and boat businesses are reserved for Zanzibaris, and a Kenyan and two Ugandans are, in law, foreigners (The Citizen, 21–22 Aug) — awkwardly against the EAC Common Market Protocol, as the reporting notes.

Alone, a compliance story. Beside the week, something larger. Nairobi wants the Tourism Fund to keep collecting the 2% hotel levy while the CS oversees spending (Capital FM, 21 Aug). Dodoma is handing TANAPA and Ngorongoro back 51% of collected revenue (Pindi Chana, May 2026). Kigali prices a gorilla at US\$1,500 on the wrong passport, about US\$200 on an EAC one (RDB, 2026). None generates a visitor. Each redistributes money that already exists.

What everyone is missing: the perimeter is drawn at the national border, not the EAC one — exactly where the growth guest now comes from. Kenyan residents were 45% of hotel occupancy in 2025 (KNBS, Apr 2026); Uganda sent Kenya 234,556 arrivals. And your growth is migrating out of room revenue into the experience layer — permits, gates, transfers, excursions — which is the layer being nationalised. Where your margin now sits, the state is not just your tax collector but your licensor.

THE WEEK'S SIGNALS

1 ZANZIBAR ARRESTS EAC CITIZENS AS "FOREIGNERS"

One Kenyan, two Ugandans, detained 18 Aug for excursion work reserved for Zanzibaris (The Citizen, 21–22 Aug).

So what: audit every excursion, transfer and boat product you sell or subcontract for the licence holder's nationality. Liability doesn't stop at your paperwork.

Beach | ZNZ/KE/UG | Confirmed | impact:risk

2 NAIROBI REWRITES WHO CONTROLS THE 2% LEVY

Fund keeps collecting, CS oversees management; the Bill widens the Fund into marketing and product (Capital FM, 21 Aug).

So what: file during public participation. This decides whether your levy funds marketing you benefit from, or institutions you don't.

City/Bush/Beach | KE | Confirmed | impact:margin

3 TANZANIA HANDS THE PARKS BACK 51% OF THE GATE

Retained in Bank of Tanzania special accounts, released with Paymaster General approval (Pindi Chana, May 2026).

So what: a park funding its own roads has the motive to reprice them. Model an increase into

2027/28 costings now.

Bush | Tanzania | Confirmed | impact:watch

4 UGANDA IS THE COUNTER-EXAMPLE

UCAA reviewed 15 air service licence applications — 10 new — on 12 June 2026; Entebbe handled 189,130 international passengers in April.

So what: Uganda is opening the layer everyone else closes. Build Entebbe into 2027 circuits before it prices itself.

City/Bush | UG | Confirmed | impact:demand

30/90-DAY DEMAND CALENDAR

26 Aug — Cabinet takes the 2026 BRP. Check it for a named tourism charge.

4 Sep — Kwaita Izina, Kinigi. Musanze tightens. Package the transfer night.

~15 Sep — EPRA fuel review effective. Diesel above KSh217.86/L reprices every transfer.

6-8 Oct — Magical Kenya Travel Expo (10,000+, KTB). Block buyer and crew rooms now.

27 Oct / 18 Nov — Uganda Airlines opens Entebbe-Accra, then Entebbe-Kigali. Build the twin-centre first.

Are you pricing the regional guest as one market, or five?

This edition on the web: <https://eahospitalitypulse.com/editions/foresight-2026-08-23.html>

This week's Big Read on LinkedIn: <https://www.linkedin.com/company/ea-hospitality-pulse/>

Get every brief — Telegram: t.me/africabusinessriskreview | LinkedIn: [linkedin.com/company/ea-hospitality-pulse](https://www.linkedin.com/company/ea-hospitality-pulse/) | Web: eahospitalitypulse.com

Kenya · Uganda · Tanzania · Zanzibar · Rwanda. Intelligence for city, bush & beach — so you can decide, not just react.